

FIELD LIBRARY / FULL FIELD GUIDE

Household emergency plan

PREPAREDNESS / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Agree on how to receive warnings, where to shelter, when and where to evacuate, and how to reconnect if separated. Write the plan down and include people who need medication, mobility assistance or caregiver support.

Do now.

**Identify local risks**

01

Use local emergency management information and plan for likely hazards.

**Choose meeting places**

02

Pick a nearby safe place and an out-of-area destination plus backup routes.

**Assign contact arrangements**

03

Name an out-of-area contact, write phone numbers and agree on check-in times.

**Practice and update**

04

Run a simple drill and revise for changes in health, school, work or pets.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Give each household member a written copy with two meeting places, two contacts and essential medical details. Practise the plan with phones off. Include a destination you can actually reach without an official shelter or rescue transport.

Watch for.

A plan that depends on one vehicle or one working phone network needs alternatives.

People & practical needs.

Write the plan in formats everyone can use: plain text, large print, translated wording or another needed communication format. Ask each person which assistance they want. Store private identity and health details securely rather than in public shared links.

Keep essentials within reach.

Prioritize supplies named in this guide that are usable by the person who needs them. Keep the checklist and relevant contact details accessible. Check carrying capacity, storage and equipment instructions in advance; collecting equipment must not delay the immediate protective action.

Next decisions.

Keep copies offline and in go bags. Share relevant details with caregivers and trusted contacts.

Questions in the field.

What if people are in different places?

Choose a nearby meeting point and a second place outside the likely affected area. Give everyone an out-of-area contact and decide how to report safe status without exposing precise locations publicly. Practice the plan without a working mobile network.

What if the chosen contact cannot respond?

Name a backup and a reassessment time before an event. Do not keep traveling between unchecked addresses. Agree what each person will do if no message gets through and who is responsible for dependents at school, work or home.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

NEXT ACTION / PERSON RESPONSIBLE

Sources & limits.

Civilian educational guidance. Linked references may use U.S. emergency systems; local warning methods, laws, services and conditions differ.

Source-linked editorial guidance. Not independent clinical or specialist certification. Training and product-specific instructions remain essential.

[Household emergency plan · official guidance](#)

<https://www.ready.gov/plan>

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/preparedness/household-emergency-plan/>

Content updated 2026-10-02. Saved guidance cannot provide live alerts.